Reading_RevisionSheet

Reading Comprehension — Revision Sheet

A one-page strategy guide for the KS2 SATs Reading test.

The paper at a glance

- **1 hour. Around 50 marks. Usually 3 texts.**
- Texts get **harder as you go**: easiest first, hardest last.
- A mix of **fiction, non-fiction, and sometimes a poem**.
- You can read the texts and answer questions **in any order** — but most people do best going **text by text**.

A simple plan for the hour

1. **Read the first text properly** (about 5 minutes). Don't skim — you'll need detail.
2. **Answer that text's questions** while it's fresh in your mind (about 10–12 minutes).
3. Repeat for text 2, then text 3.
4. **Save 5 minutes at the end** to go back to any question you skipped or weren't sure about.

> *If a question is hard, **put a star next to it and move on**. Come back later. Don't lose easy marks at the end because you got stuck on a 3-marker.*

The 6 question types (and how to spot them)

1. Retrieval — "Find and copy..."

- The answer is **in the text**. Don't invent or paraphrase.
- Copy the **exact** word or phrase.
- Look out for "find and copy **one** word" vs "find and copy **a phrase**" (a phrase = more than one word).

2. Vocabulary — "What does X mean?" / "Which word is closest in meaning to...?"

- Read the **whole sentence** the word is in — context is the biggest clue.
- For multiple choice, **cross out** options you're sure are wrong first.

3. **Inference** — "How do you know…?" / "Why does the character feel…?"

- The answer is **not** directly stated. You have to be a detective.
- **Always include evidence from the text.** A good answer is: *point + quote + brief explanation*.
- Format: "*X feels nervous because the text says '…', which suggests…*".

4. **Authorial intent** — "Why has the writer chosen this word/phrase/structure?"

- Think about the **effect on the reader**: tension, sadness, humour, suspense, vivid picture.
- Useful sentence starter: "*The writer uses ____ to make the reader feel/imagine ____*."

5. **Summary / sequencing** — "Number these events 1–5" / "Summarise paragraph 2"

- For sequencing: find the **first event** first, then the last, then fill in the middle.
- For summarising: stick to the **main idea**, not every detail.

6. **Comparison / overview** — "How is X different at the start and end?" / "How does the writer show…?"

- These are usually the **3-mark** questions at the end.
- Give **three** clear points, ideally with a short quote for each.
- A simple table works for "give 3 impressions" questions.

Marks vs effort — a golden rule

Marks	Roughly how much to write
1 mark	One word or a short phrase (often just "find and copy").
2 marks	**Two** points, or **one point + evidence**.
3 marks	**Three** clear points, or a point with **two pieces of evidence + explanation**.

> *If a question is worth **3 marks**, do **not** write one line. Examiners are looking for three things.*

Common traps to avoid

- ❌ **Writing too much for a 1-marker.** You only get one mark — move on.
- ❌ **Quoting without explaining.** A quote on its own often gets 0. Always link it back to the question.
- ❌ **Answering in your own words when it says "find and copy".** Just copy. Spelling doesn't have to be perfect, but words must match.
- ❌ **Forgetting to look at the right paragraph.** If the question says "look at paragraph 3", only paragraph 3 counts.
- ❌ **Ticking two boxes when it says "tick one"** — automatic 0.

Useful sentence starters for longer answers

- *"This suggests that..."*
- *"The word ___ makes the reader feel/think..."*
- *"We can tell ___ because the text says '___'."*
- *"At the start ___, but by the end ___."*
- *"The writer creates ___ by ___."*

Night-before checklist ✅

- Read for **20 minutes** of anything you enjoy — a novel, a magazine, a non-fiction article. Reading the night before warms up the brain.
- Sleep early. Tired eyes miss key words.
- In the morning: a proper breakfast, a glass of water, and remember — **read the question twice** before you answer.

You've got this, Srita! 🌟 📖